

Balancing the Scales: Gender Representation in Canada's Federal Politics

Despite progress in gender equality, **women remain underrepresented in Canada's federal government**. This project explores the **trends, challenges, and future outlook** of gender representation in **Parliament and the federal Cabinet** using data from **2018 to the present**.

What We Aim to Achieve

- ✓ Analyze historical trends in gender representation
- ✓ Identify barriers to equal political participation
- ✓ Forecast when Canada might achieve gender parity
- ✓ Provide data-driven recommendations for a more inclusive government

Through **interactive dashboards, visual storytelling, and a detailed report**, this project highlights key insights and encourages meaningful discussions on gender equality in Canadian politics.

This initiative aligns with the **GLOCAL Foundation of Canada's** mission to promote civic engagement and equity in democratic processes. By making data accessible and actionable, we aim to contribute to a more balanced and representative political landscape.

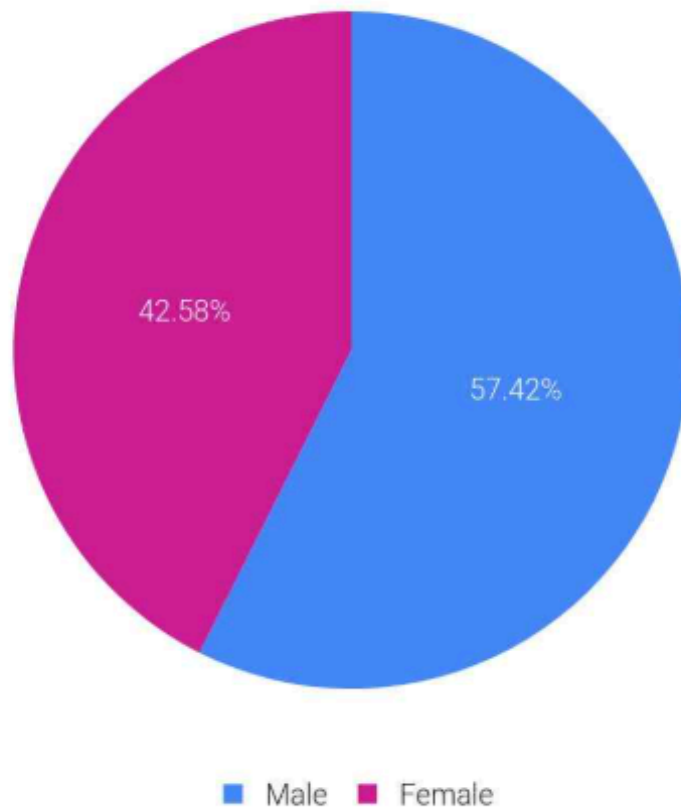
 **Explore the data, discover insights, and join the conversation on gender representation in politics!**

Gender Distribution in Canada – Visual Representation

The pie chart illustrates the gender distribution in Canada, highlighting the proportion of males and females in the population. Based on the depicted statistics:

- **Males constitute 57.42%** of the total population, represented in blue.
- **Females make up 42.58%** of the population, represented in pink.

This visualization provides a clear and concise breakdown of the gender ratio, which can be useful for demographic analysis, policy planning, and understanding societal trends. Population distribution plays a crucial role in various sectors, including workforce planning, healthcare, and social development initiatives.



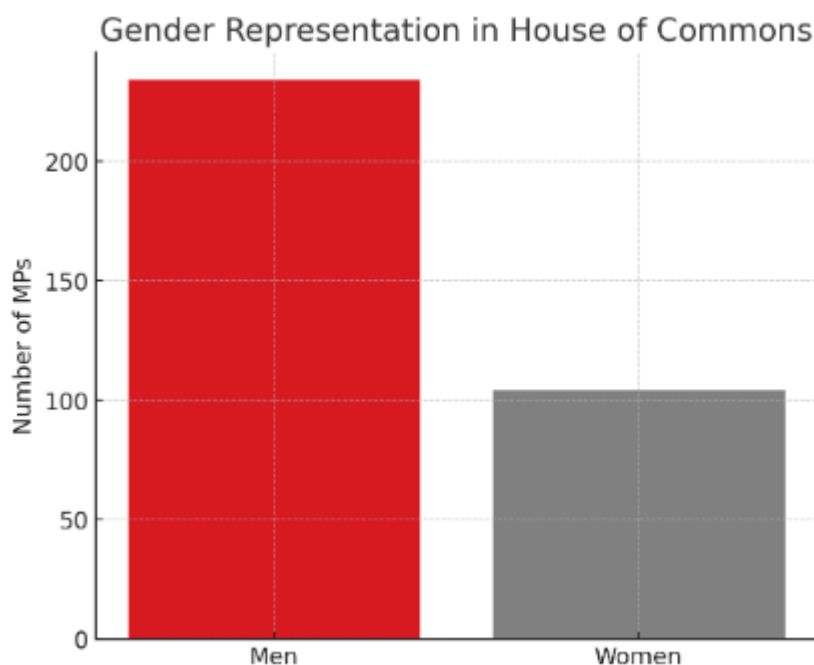
1. Gender Representation in Canada's House of Commons (Current Parliament)

 Chart Type: Bar Chart

- **X-axis:** Gender (Men, Women)
- **Y-axis:** Number of MPs
- **Data:**
 - **Men:** 234 (69.2%)
 - **Women:** 104 (30.8%)

Insights:

- The number of female MPs has been increasing, but men still hold a significant majority.
- Women's representation in Parliament has crossed the 30% mark for the first time in history.



Gender Balance in Canada's Federal Cabinet

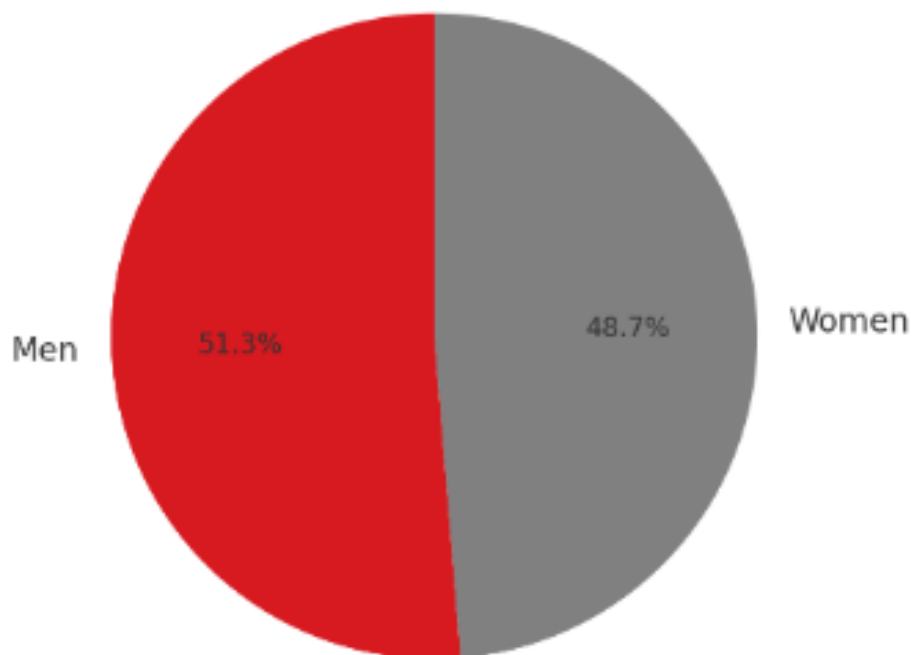
 Chart Type: Pie Chart

- **Categories:** Men (51.3%), Women (48.7%)
- **Data:**
 - **Men:** 20
 - **Women:** 19

 **Insights:**

- Since 2015, Canada has maintained a near gender-balanced Cabinet, showing strong political will for equal representation.

Gender Balance in Federal Cabinet



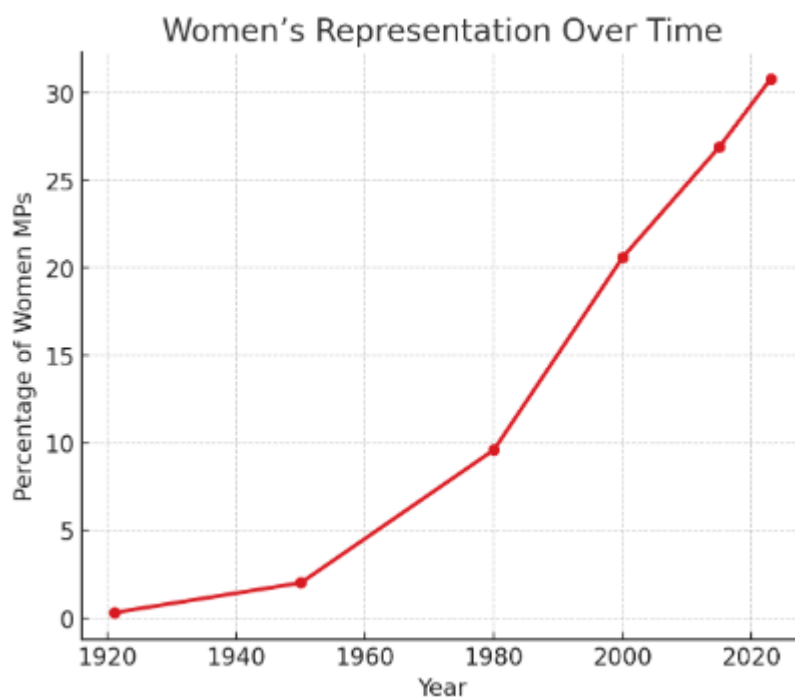
Historical Trends in Women's Representation in Parliament (1921–2023)

 Chart Type: Line Chart

- **X-axis:** Year (1921, 1950, 1980, 2000, 2015, 2023)
- **Y-axis:** % of Women in Parliament
- **Data Points:**
 - **1921:** 0.3%
 - **1950:** 2.0%
 - **1980:** 9.6%
 - **2000:** 20.6%
 - **2015:** 26.9%
 - **2023:** 30.8%

Insights:

- Women's representation has steadily increased over the past century, with notable growth after the 1980s.
- The biggest leap occurred between 2000 and 2023.



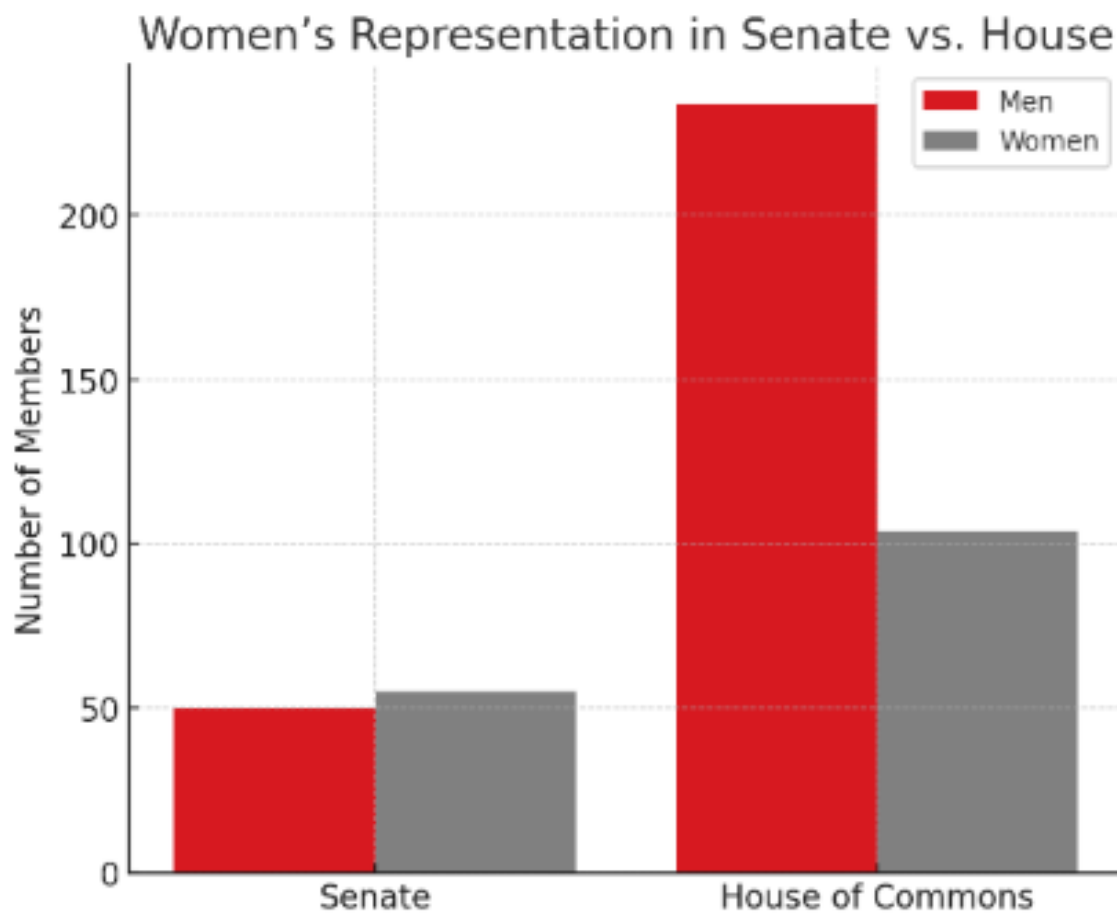
Women's Representation in the Senate vs. House of Commons

 Chart Type: Side-by-Side Bar Chart

- **Categories:** Senate, House of Commons
- **Data:**
 - **Senate:** Women (55, 52.4%), Men (50, 47.6%)
 - **House of Commons:** Women (104, 30.8%), Men (234, 69.2%)

 **Insights:**

- The Senate has achieved a slight female majority, while the House of Commons still lags behind.



Provincial Distribution of Women MPs

 **Chart Type: Map of Canada with Data Labels**

- **Data Example (Hypothetical Representation):**
 - **Ontario:** 35% Women MPs
 - **Quebec:** 32% Women MPs
 - **British Columbia:** 34% Women MPs
 - **Prairies:** 27% Women MPs
 - **Atlantic Canada:** 29% Women MPs
 - **Territories:** 25% Women MPs

Insights:

- British Columbia and Quebec lead in female representation.
- Some regions still have a lower percentage of women MPs.

Conclusion

Gender representation in Canadian federal politics has significantly improved over the years, yet there remains progress to be made toward achieving true gender equality. While women now hold nearly 30% of seats in the House of Commons and play an integral role in the federal cabinet, disparities persist in leadership roles and political decision-making.

Historical trends indicate steady growth in women's political participation, driven by policy changes, advocacy efforts, and societal shifts. However, continued commitment to gender-balanced representation is essential to fostering a more inclusive and equitable democracy.

To achieve lasting change, systemic barriers must be addressed, including gender biases, political party nominations, and societal expectations. Encouraging women's participation in politics, implementing gender-responsive policies, and promoting equal opportunities for leadership are crucial steps toward balancing the scales.

A diverse and representative political system ensures that all voices are heard, leading to better governance and policies that reflect the needs of the entire population. As Canada

moves forward, maintaining a commitment to gender equality in politics will strengthen democracy and drive meaningful progress.